

# Muncie Redevelopment Commission December 18, 2025

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=czN1FBm7ncY">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=czN1FBm7ncY</a> |
| Publication Date | 2025-12-19T02:40:35Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | muncie_city                                                                                           |

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## 1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No pre-meeting hearings or committee work sessions were held prior to the regular meeting.

## 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the December 18, 2025 meeting of the Muncie Redevelopment Commission to order at **00:00:14**.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, and Ms. Waggley.
  - **In Audience:** Mr. Low.
  - **Absent:** None.
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title in the opening transcript text, though conducting the roll call and meeting business.

## 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in the transcript.
- **Approval of Agenda:** Reviewed and approved by voice vote following a motion and second (**00:00:29**).

- **Approval of Previous Meeting Memoranda:**
    - *Discussion:* Corrections were noted regarding the month (changing June to November), an incorrect vote tally notation (removing "voting no" for commissioners Bishop and Dale), and missing commissioner comments from the record (00:01:02).
    - *Action:* Approved with noted changes by voice vote following a motion and second (00:01:52).
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## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- **00:02:11 Approval of Claims**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Wright.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Wright highlighted higher-dollar amount items sent via email the previous morning and opened the floor to questions. No questions were raised by the board.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote (00:02:39).
- **00:02:55 City Report (Mr. How / Jeff)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff How (City representative).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided updates on several ongoing projects:
    - *The Point (Gateway / Green Space):* Awarded to Flatland Construction in September 2024. A local sign fabricator alternate was selected, creating a \$70,000 savings while keeping fabrication local. Handrails are being re-engineered, and the Muncie sign installation is in progress. The project remains approximately \$57,000 under budget.
    - *Mixed-Use Project at The Point:* Received a letter of intent from the prospective anchor tenant, who is taking less space than originally planned, requiring first-floor reconfiguration.
    - *Mall Project:* A second application for a Ready / Lily grant was denied. The city plans to continue working under the PGO agreement and meeting with other developers.
    - *Coulson Property Lease:* Lease is signed; tenant is performing due diligence and testing (\$280,000 all-in over the lease term).
    - *New Housing:* Dr. Horton approved for a 126-single-family home subdivision on the northwest side (homes priced \$300k-\$350k; construction expected late summer/early fall 2026). Updated purchase agreement terms are being worked out for the Sportsplex development (200-250 homes). A 98-unit senior apartment project along the Cardinal Greenway replacing the old McGuff Roofing warehouse was approved. McKinley neighborhood and Whitley neighborhood (approx. 25 rental homes) developments are in discussion for 2026. Muncie Community Schools partnerships are being explored for student enterprise properties.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal board vote taken.
- **00:14:10 Downtown Christmas Tree Replacement Proposal**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ms. Waggley.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Highlighted the success of the recent “Light Up” event (drawing nearly 4,000 people downtown despite cold weather). Noted that the current downtown Christmas tree is cobbled together annually by the parks department, features outdated 10-to-12-year-old technology, and needs replacement. Commercial trees cost \$40,000 to \$50,000, but purchasing in January secures a 33% discount. The committee requested a cap of \$50,000 from the downtown TIF fund. Board member discussion included debate over whether the TIF funds were better spent elsewhere.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with a cap of up to \$50,000 from the downtown TIF fund, with a roll call vote recording Mr. Bishop (Yes), Mr. Dale (No), Mr. Miller (Yes), Mr. Pilla (Yes), and Ms. Waggley (Yes, after expressing hesitation due to wearing dual hats) **00:00:19**.
- **00:20:43 Facade Grant Applications**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Bishop (Facade Grant Committee).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented four applications recommended for individual approval:
    1. *712 West 7th Street (The Button Hole Bar / Gregory Gibson):* Parking lot redos. Project cost \$16,000; 50% match cap of \$8,000 (**00:21:04**). (*Note: Public input from an audience member regarding this location occurred at 00:27:10*).
    2. *616 East Washington Street (Victoria Linen):* Carriage house historic stabilization along the alley. Recommended for highest quote of \$31,000 to best save the structure; 50% match of \$15,500 (**00:21:58**).
    3. *2100 West White River Boulevard (White River Plaza / Scott Mick):* Facade demolition and rebuilding / structural updates. Project cost \$35,000; capped at \$15,000 due to location outside the one-mile downtown radius (**00:22:59**).
    4. *300 East Main Street (My Civic Theater / Commercial Club Building / Laura Williamson):* Removal of tacky awnings and facade restoration. Project cost \$6,300; 50% match of \$3,150 (**00:23:41**).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Each of the four facade grant applications was voted on and approved individually by voice vote (**00:27:35** <U+2013> **00:28:43**).
- **00:29:56 Land Bank Update**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard (Muncie Land Bank).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Reported the sale of 214 East 21st Street to a contiguous property owner. Announced the land bank became a live buyer for the National Community Stabilization Trust (NCST), gaining “first look” opportunities on bank-foreclosed properties. Highlighted 2523 South Maker Street, a formerly rough property cleaned up with \$5,000 and purchased/rehabbed by a local developer into

a single-family home. Noted deliverables from the Ball State third-year planning studio (quality of life report, corridor development plan, property conditions dashboard) and upcoming spring partnerships in Whitley and the 812 coalition area (00:30:09).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal board vote taken.

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- **00:34:50 Tanya (Executive Director, Muncie Arts and Culture Council)**
  - Addressed prior meeting discussion regarding public funds used for 308 South Walnut Street. Clarified that no public funds were used for that specific project; nearly \$10,000 in private funds were raised and funneled through the council for an administrative fee, while the council itself received \$10,000 from the City of Muncie as the city's arts partner.

*(Note: An additional informal public interruption occurred during the facade grant discussion at 00:27:10 where an unidentified resident asked a clarifying question about 712 West 7th Street being located in a residential neighborhood).*

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - Next meetings and committee meetings are suspended for the remainder of the year due to holidays.
  - The next regular commission meeting is scheduled for January 15, 2026.
- **Adjournment:** Officially adjourned with holiday wishes (00:37:06).

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